# MEET the grain



# Rice Flour & Chia Flour

## Gluten Free Alternatives

Rice flour offers lots of benefits and is versatile in numerous products and recipes - from pancake mix, baby foods, and baked snacks as well as crusts for fried foods. Its inclusion and importance in the diet is partially due to its gluten-free characteristics.

Rice flour is low in sodium, saturated fat and cholesterol. It is also rich in calories (same as its counterpart) with a mixture of complex nutrients and carbohydrates.

Rice flour has insoluble fiber which creates a healthier profile. In addition, it is abundant in resistant starch which encourages the development of healthy bacteria. It is easy to digest with mild taste due to its gluten-free quality.

Rice flour is also good to the skin. It aids and treats pigmentation and wrinkles, as well as blemishes. When one tablespoon full of rice flour is combined with two tablespoons of yogurt, the solution serves as a skin cleansing milk which is proven to be effective and reliable. Helping to bring back the skin's beauty is certainly a great selling point of this efficient ingredient!

We love the many nutritional benefits that chia seeds and "flour" made from chia seeds can add to your diet:

- **They're a great source of omega-3 fatty acids;**
- **they increase hydration, and**
- **they've been shown to help lower blood pressure and control blood sugar.**
- **To top it all off, they're also gluten- free.**

Substituting chia flour or meal for regular flour in a recipe is relatively simple. Some people just replace all of the flour with chia flour, and others use a combination of chia flour and regular or gluten-free flour. Using all chia flour is okay for doughs that tend to be a bit thick or gummy anyway, but for more solid mixtures like cookie dough, it's best to use a combination of 1 part chia flour to 3 parts regular or gluten-free flour. Some solid gluten-free flour options include gluten-free all-purpose baking flour, almond flour and sweet rice flour.

Chia flour also makes a great egg substitute in vegan and vegetarian recipes. To make "chia egg substitute", mix 2 tbsp. of chia flour with ½ cup of cold water and let it stand for about 30 minutes. That makes about ¼ cup of egg substitute, which can stand in for one egg in a recipe. Make sure you mix up enough substitute to replace all the eggs in your baked good, then add it at the appointed time in the recipe.



